THE FOUNDERY CHURCH · SUNDAY, NOVEMBER 8, 2026

GIVE ME EYES TO SEE

A Study Guide on Ephesians 1:17-23: Wisdom and Revelation, Hope and Inheritance, and God's Power at Work

SERMON CONTENT

1. SAME REALITY, FULLER PICTURE

Pastor Bobby’s Liberian Grilled fish photo showed something real, but only part of it. When the whole picture appeared, nothing about the fish changed. Only the viewers' understanding changed. The same can be true of what we already know about God. We know Jesus died, rose again, and promised eternal life, but have we grasped what those truths mean? Pettiness, fear, anxiety, and constant complaining can shape the church just as they shape the culture. Last week's sermon asked God for ears to hear. This week we ask Him for eyes to see.

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2. PAUL'S PRAYER FOR BELIEVERS WHO ALREADY BELIEVE

Ephesus was full of competing religions and cultural pressure. Paul has already reminded the believers there that they are chosen, adopted, redeemed, forgiven, and sealed with the Spirit. Then he says he has not stopped praying for them. These people already knew Jesus, yet there was more to discover. Knowing Jesus is not only a decision in our past. It is a relationship in which we keep growing. Paul prays for three things: eyes to see with wisdom and revelation, eyes to see our hope and inheritance, and eyes to see God's power at work.

3. EYES TO SEE WITH WISDOM AND REVELATION

The Greek word for wisdom is sophia. The word for revelation is apokalypsis, an unveiling, like a curtain pulled back. Paul asks God to pull the curtain back for people who already believe. This is more than information. In Acts 19, new believers in Ephesus publicly burned sorcery scrolls worth fifty thousand drachmas, roughly fifty thousand days of a laborer's wages. They did not do it to earn God's love. They did it in response to a gospel that had already begun to change them. Revelation changes how we respond to God, and sometimes that means releasing what we are still holding on to.

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4. THE CENTURION WHO SAW

A Roman centurion guarding a crucifixion understood power, discipline, and what happened to those who challenged Rome. Crucifixion was Rome's public display of strength. The crowd demanded that Jesus prove who He was by coming down from the cross, but Jesus had come to give Himself, not to save Himself. After the darkness, the torn curtain, and the earthquake, the centurion exclaimed, "Surely he was the Son of God!" What the crowd read as weakness was God's redemptive purpose. We can witness what God is doing without fully understanding it, just as the Emmaus disciples later found that the facts had not changed but their understanding had. Wisdom is learning to see everything else in light of what God has revealed about Himself.

5. EYES TO SEE OUR HOPE

Paul wants believers to know this hope, not merely wish for it. Everyday hope sounds like "I hope the weather is good," which expresses a wish with no certainty. Christian hope is a confident expectation grounded in God's promises and the resurrection of Jesus. Many of us find it easy to imagine everything that could go wrong, and years of disappointment can shrink our

expectations until we stop imagining what God might do. Paul is not asking us to imagine things God has not promised. He is asking us to recognize the extraordinary things He has promised. Sometimes the greatest limit on our expectations is not what God has promised but what we have decided is no longer possible.

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6. THE HOPE OF OUR CALLING

The Greek word for called is kaleo, meaning to call or summon. God's calling is not just about finding a job or personal purpose. It is a gracious summons into a new life through Jesus. The New Testament says we are called into fellowship with Christ (1 Corinthians 1:9), freedom (Galatians 5:13), peace (Colossians 3:15), holiness (1 Thessalonians 4:7), His wonderful light (1 Peter 2:9), and eternal glory (1 Peter 5:10). Difficulty is real, but it does not write the final chapter of our story. Peter calls this a "living hope" because Jesus is alive, and it frees us from living as though everything depends on the next chapter.

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7. GOD'S TREASURED POSSESSION

Paul speaks of "the riches of his glorious inheritance in his holy people." Scholars discuss whether this means the inheritance God has prepared for us, or God's people as His inheritance. Scripture supports both. The God who owns everything, who needs nothing from us and is not made complete by us, calls His redeemed people His treasured possession (Deuteronomy 7:6; 1 Peter 2:9). Many of us measure our worth by accomplishments, possessions, appearance, influence, or other people's opinions. But our value is not something we must convince God of. His love was already shown in Christ, and our identity rests on the fact that we belong to Him.

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8. SIMPLY WANTING TO BE NEAR

In Liberia, children would come alongside the team and reach for a hand. They were not asking for anything. They just wanted to be close. Do we want to be near Jesus in the same way, not because we need Him to fix or provide something, but because being with Him is enough? Revelation 21:3-4 shows that the greatest part of our inheritance is not only that suffering ends and death is defeated. It is that God Himself will be with us. Salvation is not only what God gives us. It is that He brings us to Himself, and when we see the riches of what He has promised, we fear less what this world can take away.

9. EYES TO SEE GOD'S POWER AT WORK

Paul could have pointed to creation, the Red Sea, or Jericho. He points to the resurrection instead. On Friday it looked as if Rome had won, but Sunday revealed what Friday could not. The same power that raised Jesus from the dead is at work for those who believe. This does not mean every difficulty disappears. It means our confidence is not in our own ability but in the God we belong to. Sometimes we focus so much on what we can see that we forget who God is.

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10. OPEN HIS EYES, LORD

In 2 Kings 6, Elisha's servant woke to find Dothan surrounded by an enemy army. The danger was real. Elisha, standing in the same place, responded differently. He did not ask God to remove the army. He prayed, "Open his eyes,

LORD, so that he may see." The heavenly forces were already there, and the servant's circumstances did not change, only his understanding of them. His fear was based on something real, but not on everything that was real. Our limitations may be real, but they are not the measure of God's power.

11. NOT POWERLESS, BUT POWER-FILLED

Some of us have spent years believing we are not enough because someone told us so, or because life knocked us down. This is not a promise that we can do anything we set our minds to. It is a promise that if we belong to Jesus, we are not powerless. The Spirit of the living God is at work in us, not because we earned it, but because we belong to Jesus (Ephesians 3:20). Paul says God's power is made perfect in weakness (2 Corinthians 12:9), so weakness is not a disqualification. We do not have to be powerhouses. We belong to the One who has all power.

12. CHRIST, THE HEAD OF HIS BODY, THE CHURCH

Jesus is seated far above every ruler, authority, power, and name, and God appointed Him head over everything for the church. The church's future rests on His authority, not on our ability to impress. The church is His body, which means it is a people we belong to, not just a place we go on Sundays. Hebrews 10:24-25 calls us to spur one another on and keep meeting together. When someone is missing from the body, it matters, and we are called to reach out in love, not judgment. The body of Christ is also larger than any one congregation. The churches in Liberia have different buildings and resources but the same Jesus, gospel, and Spirit.

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13. THE JOY SET BEFORE HIM

The centurion saw the suffering of the cross, but we also know the empty tomb. Hebrews 12:2 says Jesus endured the cross "for the joy set before him." Part of that joy is redeeming a people to call His own. You are His treasure, and He delights in you, rejoicing over you with singing (Zephaniah 3:17). Before we ever reached for Him, He acted to bring us near: Christ suffered "to bring you to God" (1 Peter 3:18). Seeing this should change how we face life, the future, God's calling, and the mission of the church, because Jesus is alive, reigning, and not finished.

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14. THIS WEEK'S CHALLENGE: KEEP ASKING

Paul wrote, "I keep asking." He did not pray once and move on. The challenge is to pray a prayer inspired by Ephesians 1 every day for the rest of the year, not as a formula but because every follower of Jesus should want God to answer it. Pray it in the morning and in the car, when fear shows up, when offense comes, and when you are tempted to believe you are not enough. The prayer asks for wisdom and revelation to know God more deeply, eyes opened to our hope and calling, an understanding of God's resurrection power at work in us, a life lived under Christ's authority, and faithful belonging to His church.

15. PRACTICAL APPLICATION EXERCISES

Name one thing you know is true about Jesus (for example, He is risen, He is faithful, or He holds all authority) and write how it should change a fear or worry you face this week. Identify one "scroll" you may still be holding on to, such as a habit, belief, or source of security, and bring it to God in prayer. Write down one area where you have stopped expecting God to act, and ask Him to renew your hope there. Think of one person who has been absent from church, and send them a message this week saying you miss them and love them. Pray the Ephesians 1 prayer each day and record what you notice.

SCRIPTURE REFERENCES

Ephesians 1:17-23
"I keep asking that the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the glorious Father, may give you the Spirit of wisdom and revelation, so that you may know him better. I pray that the eyes of your heart may be enlightened in order that you may know the hope to which he has called you, the riches of his glorious inheritance in his holy people, and his incomparably great power for us who believe. That power is the same as the mighty strength he exerted when he raised Christ from the dead and seated him at his right hand in the heavenly realms, far above all rule and authority, power and dominion, and every name that is invoked, not only in the present age but also in the one to come. And God placed all things under his feet and appointed him to be head over everything for the church, which is his body, the fullness of him who fills everything in every way."
(NIV)

Acts 19:19
"A number who had practiced sorcery brought their scrolls together and burned them publicly. When they calculated the value of the scrolls, the total came to fifty thousand drachmas."
(NIV)

Matthew 27:54
"When the centurion and those with him who were guarding Jesus saw the earthquake and all that had happened, they were terrified, and exclaimed, "Surely he was the Son of God!""
(NIV)

Mark 15:39
"And when the centurion, who stood there in front of Jesus, saw how he died, he said, "Surely this man was the Son of God!""
(NIV)

Luke 24:27
"And beginning with Moses and all the Prophets, he explained to them what was said in all the Scriptures concerning himself."

(NIV)

1 Peter 1:3-4
"Praise be to the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ! In his great mercy he has given us new birth into a living hope through the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead, and into an inheritance that can never perish, spoil or fade. This inheritance is kept in heaven for you."
(NIV)

Deuteronomy 7:6
"For you are a people holy to the LORD your God. The LORD your God has chosen you out of all the peoples on the face of the earth to be his people, his treasured possession."
(NIV)

1 Peter 2:9
"But you are a chosen people, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, God's special possession, that you may declare the praises of him who called you out of darkness into his wonderful light."
(NIV)

Revelation 21:3-4
"And I heard a loud voice from the throne saying, "Look! God's dwelling place is now among the people, and he will dwell with them. They will be his people, and God himself will be with them and be their God. He will wipe every tear from their eyes. There will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain, for the old order of things has passed away.""
(NIV)

2 Kings 6:15-17
"When the servant of the man of God got up and went out early the next morning, an army with horses and chariots had surrounded the city. "Oh no, my lord! What shall we do?" the servant asked. "Don't be afraid," the prophet answered. "Those who are with us are more than those who are with them." And Elisha prayed, "Open his eyes, LORD, so that he may see." Then the LORD opened the servant's eyes, and he looked and saw the hills full of horses and chariots of fire all around Elisha."
(NIV)

Ephesians 3:20
"Now to him who is able to do immeasurably more than all we ask or imagine, according to his power that is at work within us,"
(NIV)

2 Corinthians 12:9
"But he said to me, "My grace is sufficient for you, for my power is made perfect in weakness.""
(NIV)

Hebrews 10:24-25
"And let us consider how we may spur one another on toward love and good deeds, not giving up meeting together, as some are in the habit of doing, but encouraging one another."
(NIV)

Hebrews 12:2
"fixing our eyes on Jesus, the pioneer and perfecter of faith. For the joy set before him he endured the cross, scorning its shame, and sat down at the right hand of the throne of God."
(NIV)

Zephaniah 3:17
"The LORD your God is with you, the Mighty Warrior who saves. He will take great delight in you; in his love he will no longer rebuke you, but will rejoice over you with singing."
(NIV)

1 Peter 3:18
"For Christ also suffered once for sins, the righteous for the unrighteous, to bring you to God. He was put to death in the flesh but made alive in the Spirit."
(NIV)

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

For personal reflection or group discussion

1. The fish photo looked different once the whole picture was shown. Where in your life has a fuller understanding changed how you saw something that was already true?

Your thoughts:
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2. Paul prays for believers who already know Jesus. In what ways do you sense there is still more to discover about God?

Your thoughts:
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3. Acts 19 describes believers burning valuable scrolls in response to the gospel. What might be the modern equivalent of those scrolls in your life, and what would it look like to release them?

Your thoughts:
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4. The crowd read the cross as weakness, but the centurion recognized the Son of God. When have you misread a situation in your life that God later revealed to be part of His purpose?

Your thoughts:
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5. How does Christian hope differ from the way we ordinarily use the word? Where have you let past disappointments shrink your expectations of what God can do?

Your thoughts:
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6. Read the passages about God's calling (1 Corinthians 1:9, Galatians 5:13, Colossians 3:15, 1 Thessalonians 4:7, 1 Peter 2:9, 1 Peter 5:10). Which one speaks to you most right now, and why?

Your thoughts:
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7. How do you tend to measure your own value? How does being called God's treasured possession challenge that?

Your thoughts:
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8. Do you simply want to be near Jesus the way the children in Liberia wanted to hold hands? What gets in the way of that desire?

Your thoughts:
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9. Elisha's servant saw the army but not the protection of God. What are the armies you see right now, and what might God want you to see beyond them?

Your thoughts:
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10. Where have you used weakness or inadequacy as a reason to disqualify yourself? How does 2 Corinthians 12:9 speak to that?

Your thoughts:
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11. The sermon called us to remember people who may not be in church for a multitude of reasons... Who comes to mind, and what is one simple, loving way you could reach out this week?

Your thoughts:
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12. What would change about how you face fear, offense, and the future if you prayed the Ephesians 1 prayer every day?

Your thoughts:
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KEY TAKEAWAYS

Main points to remember and apply

1. Knowing facts about Jesus is different from understanding their significance, and Paul prays that believers would see more.
2. Revelation does not only change what we know about God. It changes how we respond to Him.
3. Christian hope is a confident expectation grounded in God's promises and the resurrection, not a wish.
4. God has called us into a new life with Him, and difficulty is never the end of our story.
5. The God who owns everything calls His redeemed people His treasured possession, so our identity rests on belonging to Him.
6. The greatest part of our inheritance is being with God, and Christ suffered to bring us to Him.
7. The same power that raised Jesus from the dead is at work in believers, and God's power is made perfect in our weakness.
8. Jesus is head of the church, and the church is a body we belong to, not just a place we attend.
9. Pray the Ephesians 1 prayer daily and ask God to open the eyes of your heart.

ADDITIONAL NOTES

• What stood out to you in the section on wisdom and revelation? _____
• What does it mean for you personally that you are God's treasured possession? _____
• What "army" are you facing right now, and what might God be asking you to see? _____
• Who is God bringing to mind that you can reach out to this week? _____
• What is one step of obedience you will take this week? _____
• Prayer journal: Record what you notice as you pray the Ephesians 1 prayer each day. _____

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